



PROGRESS REPORT

Namibia: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 133 systems and instruments tracked

Of 133 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 67 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-26, 35 did not, 19 carry no stated baseline, and 12 are **Not held** at both ends.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Shape check, run before the comparison: 132 sources for this place in the window — 27 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-02), 105 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Namibia's twelve months to 6 August 2026 delivered networks and deferred statutes. Commercial fifth-generation service, a privately owned mobile network and 25 new towers all entered service inside the window ([launch account](#)); the Data Protection Bill missed a September 2025 tabling and the electronic signature regime missed a February 2026 deployment, and both are marked *Stalled* ([tabling announcement](#)).

The regulatory decision of the period was a refusal. A satellite operator's licence application went from pending, with a ministerial ownership exemption under review, to refused on 23 March 2026 and upheld on 22 June after 624 reconsideration requests were dismissed ([regulator account](#)).

Namibia is the one country in this batch with no coverage cliff: its base runs continuously across the window, so the ten rows carrying no baseline are genuinely unestablished positions rather than an artefact of when the wiki started reading.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Artificial-intelligence legislation	BASELINE NOT HELD	Announced as following the strategy; nothing drafted or tabled	<i>Baseline not held</i>

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National artificial-intelligence strategy	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under development through the research council's working group and its technical advisory committees, with consultations begun; no draft published, and the ministry states the strategy is sequenced ahead of legislation	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Corporate Laws Bill 2025	Did not exist	At Draft 3 and out for public comment: it consolidates and re-enacts the Companies Act with the business and intellectual property authority as registrar, and clause 114 would require every company, and every external company establishing a place of business in Namibia, to keep in Namibia a register of beneficial owners recording each owner's name, date of birth, identity-document number and residential, business, email and postal addresses; company process is routed through the Electronic Transactions Act	ADVANCED
Cybercrime Bill	No bill named on the record; enforcement relying on the electronic transactions statute, the communications statute and the penal code	Named by the minister as being finalised alongside the data protection bill; no draft published and no tabling date given	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Data Protection Bill	A tabling announced for September 2025, about twelve years after drafting began	Not tabled and not enacted; no data-protection statute in force at 2026-08-06	STALLED
Data Protection Bill, latest published draft	The March 2022 revised draft, 59 pages and eight Parts, the last version published for comment	The March 2022 revised draft remains the last version published for comment, with the supervisory authority at its Part 2; the draft's stated objects are establishing a Data Protection Supervisory Authority with its own powers and duties, obligations on data controllers and processors, rights for data subjects, and codes of conduct; the 2020 version is held alongside it, and no later text and no tabling record has been published	NO CHANGE
Electronic Transactions Act 2019	In force; covers electronic signatures, consumer protection and contracts but not cross-border data flow, data localisation or personal data protection	Unchanged; still the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime, with the communications statute and the penal code	NO CHANGE

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Gazette notice withdrawing existing identity documents	Did not exist	Named by the home affairs ministry as the instrument that will end the validity of pre-independence cards, older identity documents and current machine-readable cards; not issued	ADVANCED
Data-subject rights provisions of the Data Protection Bill	Recorded as removed on a research institute's account; neither draft held	Established from the drafts themselves: the 2020 version carries Part III, "Rights of the Data Subject", sections 8 to 14, together with Part VII on recourse to the judicial authority and Part VIII on offences and penalties, none of which appears in the 59-page, eight-Part version the ministry published for comment in March 2022, where access and correction survive only as controller obligations at sections 31 and 32	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Namibia's seat on an international artificial-intelligence commission	Did not exist	The ICT minister is one of eight Africans on a 44-member commission	ADVANCED
Namibia-Angola information technology and media memorandum	Did not exist	Covers joint events, exchange of expertise and cybersecurity; no amount or instrument named	ADVANCED
Namibia-Botswana information and communications technology memorandum	Did not exist	Signed at Kasane on 7 August 2026 between the two ICT ministries with their operators and regulators, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills development; the two sides costed the Trans-Kalahari Corridor's remaining 4G gaps at about N\$52 million across 13 new sites, recorded the completion of a Gobabis-Buitepos fibre link now interconnecting with the Botswana backbone company at Charles Hill as the first direct cross-border fibre link between the operators, and said their two incident-response teams are deepening cooperation	ADVANCED
Namibia-Republic of Congo information technology memorandum	Did not exist	Approved at cabinet's 22nd and 23rd sittings with the ICT minister authorised to sign; no scope, sector detail, financing or signature date published	ADVANCED
Pan-African language artificial-intelligence initiative	Did not exist	Namibia one of five backing governments in a pan-African African-language initiative scaling an existing national model template; no Namibian funding, dataset or deliverable published	ADVANCED
Regional regulators' legal and policy committee	BASELINE NOT HELD	Constituted and meeting, with artificial-intelligence governance, data governance and protection, digital public infrastructure and regional regulatory harmonisation on its agenda	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Published draft and consultation record of the Data Protection Bill	Did not exist	A dated consultation record: the ministry opened public input on the draft Data Protection Bill on 2022-10-26 with a closing date of 2022-11-30, addressed to two named ministry officers; the ACTION Namibia Coalition filed a submission on the closing date, compiled by ALT Advisory and funded by the Embassy of Finland through IPPR's Democracy Report project; IPPR published the same argument as a public paper on 2022-12-14, arguing the sections on the Supervisory Authority's independence need substantial redrafting and that offences and penalties provisions are undeveloped; no ministry-published list of respondents is held, and no further consultation activity is on record since	ADVANCED

Both headline bills missed their stated dates. The Data Protection Bill was announced in August 2025 for tabling in September 2025 and was still being finalised in July 2026 ([ministerial account](#)); the Cybercrime Bill entered the record only on 13 July 2026, as another instrument being finalised.

Around them the administrative machinery advanced. The national ICT policy and the ministry's strategic plan were launched at Opuwo on 29 January 2026 ([launch account](#)), incident management guidelines were issued in April 2026, a government-sector response team was approved by cabinet in November 2025 ([cabinet account](#)), and two memoranda were signed with a public administration institute and a chamber of commerce.

That is the shape of the period: five instruments of guidance and cooperation made, and no statute. The gazette notice that would withdraw existing identity documents has not issued, so the September rollout is additive to a document estate that includes pre-independence cards.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Private mobile network investment	Did not exist	A live network with N\$600,000,000 invested in the year to September 2025, company-reported	ADVANCED
Universal service levy	A 2022 notice of intention (Government Gazette 7860, General Notice 342, 25 July 2022) withdrawn 2024-06-21 (Government Gazette 8384, General Notice 291) pending a revised evidence base	In force from 2024-09-27: levy not exceeding 0.5% of annual turnover per licensee (regulation 4 and Annexure A), a flat N\$500 floor for non-profit licensees, invoiced on audited or sworn financial statements and payable within 30 days into the Universal Service Fund; regulation 9 and Annexure B amended the 2018 universal service regulations to let the Fund receive donations or grants, which is what makes the Government of Namibia's committed funding receivable; CRAN's own reply to comments states the Gap Analysis identifies 119 locations that will remain unserved after 700/800 MHz roll-out obligations, of which government funding covers the capital cost of 42	ADVANCED
Universal Service Fund	Operating; N\$145,000,000 of seed funding over three years and a N\$31,000,000 subsidy already disbursed to the mobile operator for nine network sites (2025-03)	Operating; priority given to the five regions where 4G coverage is below 80% - Kavango West, Kavango East, Kunene, Ohangwena and Oshikoto - with 16 schools and four clinics selected for uncapped Wi-Fi, and 100 handsets distributed to learners in Kunene in February 2026, and CRAN's own Integrated Annual Report 2025 states the Fund's governance framework was developed and approved by the CRAN Board, with the Ministry's contribution given there as N\$115,000,000 over three years and a first bidding round awarding nine sites to MTC with almost N\$31,000,000 of capital subsidy across the same five regions, all schools and health facilities on those sites to receive free internet for seven years	NO CHANGE, FUNDING TOTAL UNRECONCILED

Two financing commitments entered the record within the window. The private mobile network reported N\$600m invested in the year to September 2025 ([launch account](#)), and China committed CNY 98,000,000, about US\$14.4m on the source's 2026 conversion, to the Windhoek smart-city pilot, acknowledged at the end of June 2026 ([Presidency account](#)). The Universal Service Fund published no accounts at either end of the window.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Commercial 5G network	No active commercial 5G network (ministry, 2025-06-03)	Live in Windhoek, Swakopmund and Walvis Bay; nationwide deployment stated as intended, phased and city-first	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Determination of dominant position in the telecommunications market	2016 determination (Government Gazette 6054, General Notice 214, 28 June 2016) defined the four priority markets carried forward in 2024: fixed and mobile call/SMS termination, wired end-user access, national data transmission, and wireless end-user access	2024 determination names Telecom Namibia dominant in all four markets - alone in wired end-user access, with NamPower in national data transmission, with MTC in wireless end-user access, and with MTC, UCom Mobile, Paratus and Telepassport in call and SMS termination, termination being treated as a natural monopoly; CRAN describes its approach across all three exercises (2013, 2016, 2024) as one of minimal intervention	ADVANCED
First privately owned mobile network	Announced, not launched (2025-08-19)	A national network live on long-term evolution and 5G; N\$600m invested in the network in the preceding year and N\$1.42bn in Namibian network infrastructure since 2018, company-reported	ADVANCED
Ministry strategic plan 2025-2030 and national ICT policy	None published	In force; priorities are affordable broadband and mobile coverage in rural and underserved areas, cybersecurity, data protection and electronic government; the policy names high data costs, limited infrastructure and unequal access as the barriers	ADVANCED
Regional subsea and satellite integration agreement	None published	Signed by the state fixed operator with two Angolan counterparts, with the Namibian operator as landing party hosting Angolan equipment; scope covers design, integration, testing, commissioning and handover	ADVANCED
Retirement of 2G and 3G networks	Did not exist	The regulator has instructed operators to retire 2G and 3G and refarm the spectrum for 4G and 5G; the incumbent asked government at a parliamentary committee hearing on 17 August 2026 to subsidise smartphones before the switch-off, and reported 53 sites in one Kavango region against 39 in the other, of which 50 carry 4G and one 5G	ADVANCED
Starlink operating licence	An ownership-exemption bid under ministerial review; no licence; a November 2024 cease-and-desist in force	Licence and spectrum declined 2026-03-23 on three of six statutory criteria; 622 of 624 reconsideration requests failed the legal threshold and two were refused on merits; the operator's own request of 2026-06-08 was dismissed as out of time	CLOSED
Tower-siting engagement with traditional authorities	None published	The ministry, the regulator and three operators met the traditional authorities' trust on siting delays and costs; no agreement, instrument or timetable reported	ADVANCED
Twenty-five-tower programme	Not yet inaugurated (2025-08-01)	Twenty-five towers in service across nine regions at N\$40m in total, N\$1.6m each, company-reported	ADVANCED
51% Namibian ownership requirement	In force, with a foreign-ownership exemption bid under ministerial review	In force; no exemption granted, and the regulator held that wholly foreign ownership raises questions of jurisdiction, enforceability of compliance obligations and effective oversight	NO CHANGE
CRAN Integrated Annual Report	Integrated Annual Report 2024 (approved 2024-09-06, year to 31 March 2024): a funding proposal secured a N\$115 million, three-year Universal Service Fund commitment from the Government of Namibia; broadband coverage of schools rose 31.5 points to 81.5% and of clinics 38.9 points to 88.9%; total assets N\$277.9 million, up N\$29.6 million	Integrated Annual Report 2025 (approved 2025-08-07, year to 31 March 2025): the Universal Service Fund's governance framework was approved and the Fund launched 2025-03-19 with the N\$115 million MICT commitment; a first bidding round awarded nine sites to MTC with almost N\$31 million capital subsidy across Kunene, Kavango East, Kavango West, Ohangwena and Oshikoto, with free internet for schools and clinics on the new sites for seven years; revenue fell 23% to 15.5% below budget, operating expenditure rose 42% to N\$143.1 million, and a N\$32.8 million surplus became a N\$25.5 million loss; 4G population coverage 91% and an ITU ICT Development Index of 73.2% are separately stated	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Regulator coverage and subscriber statistics	Published to 2023 data	Published inside the sector market reports: 4G population coverage 85% in 2022, with six of Namibia's 14 regions below 80% and Kunene lowest at 41%; 456 of 1,380 schools and 84 of 452 health facilities without 4G coverage in 2022; about 2,000,000 of 2,900,000 mobile SIM cards actively used for internet access in 2022; and state influence over 87% of telecommunication assets and 83% of sector revenue in 2022, moving to 82% and 80% in 2023; the 2023 edition separately gives 4G population coverage of 88.4%, FTTH at 27% of fixed broadband subscribers (more than double its 2018 share), a 6% fall in active SIM cards, and a rise from 46th to 8th in African 1GB-affordability ranking between Q1 2022 and Q1 2023, which CRAN attributes to its own broadband-price consultation	NO CHANGE
Tax relief on fourth-generation devices	BASELINE NOT HELD	Proposed; no fiscal instrument, budget line or ministerial response published, against an operator-reported utilisation close to 50% across about 74 enabled towers in the region	Baseline not held

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National and public data centre	None published	A concept note and project proposal directed to the ministry and the Office of the Prime Minister; no site, capacity, cost or date published at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED, NO DATES SET
Vendor-built national data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads	None published	A vendor building smart-city solutions and a data centre with the ICT and home affairs ministries; China committed CNY 98,000,000, given by the source as about US\$14.4m on 2026-07-08	ADVANCED
National Digital Strategy	Published August 2025	In force; the national data centre it calls for was still at concept-note stage at 2025-09-22	NO CHANGE
Commercial data centres in operation	BASELINE NOT HELD	One operator-run facility and one run by an aerospace company with a national university operating commercially	Baseline not held

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Capacity committed to the Angolan counterpart	None published	1.0 Tbps initial dedicated transmission capacity on the subsea system, per the signed agreement	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Banking fraud losses	About N\$8.7m a year (2020, central bank)	N\$73.9m for 2025, with N\$65m lost between January and October 2025	REGRESSED
Detected vulnerabilities and cyber events	2,231,970 vulnerabilities and 1.7m attacks over calendar 2025, up about 37% year on year	513,921 vulnerabilities and 161,547 events in April to June 2026, up 39.8% and 56.7% on the prior quarter	REGRESSED
Fraud and cybersecurity summit	Did not exist	Convened by the ICT ministry with the central bank, the bankers' association, the incident response team and an industry cyber council; no second edition reported	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Government-sector incident response team and security operations centres	None published	Approved as the central authority coordinating incidents across government, with the Office of the Prime Minister directed to coordinate phased implementation; no establishment, budget or timetable reported	ADVANCED, APPROVED NOT ESTABLISHED
NAM-CSIRT cybersecurity landscape report	Inaugural report (dated by proxy to January 2025, covering calendar 2024): Namibia scored 36.93 on the ITU Global Cybersecurity Index 2024 (Tier 4 Evolving), up from 11.47 in 2020; 2,727,913 vulnerabilities and five ransomware victims recorded for calendar 2024; NAM-CSIRT stated it had entered its operational phase	Second annual edition (published 2026-04-11, covering calendar 2025): 1,701,883 cyber-attack events (up about 37% on 2024) and 2,231,970 vulnerabilities recorded; five ransomware victims (Akira, Radar, Everest, INC Ransom); NAM-CSIRT states it completed Phase 3 of its three-year implementation plan in FY2025/26, marking full operationalisation, and states in its own text that it cannot fully execute its mandate absent a cybersecurity law	ADVANCED
National computer security incident response team	Operating under the regulator, publishing quarterly newsletters and an annual landscape report; about US\$1m allocated to cybersecurity for 2026/27	Operating under the regulator, publishing quarterly newsletters and an annual landscape report; about US\$1m allocated to cybersecurity for 2026/27; NAM-CSIRT joined FIRST, the SADC SR-CIRT Task Force and AfricaCERT during 2025 and established the Namibia Cyber Security Information Sharing Group	ADVANCED
National Cybersecurity Incident Management Guidelines 2026	Did not exist	In force since April 2026, setting out detection, reporting and coordinated response; detected vulnerabilities rose 39.8% in the following quarter	ADVANCED
Public-service cyber training partnership	Did not exist	A framework for joint training of public servants, extending to private-sector professionals; no funding, cohort size or delivery date published	ADVANCED
Regulator and chamber of commerce memorandum	Did not exist	A three-year memorandum with a joint steering committee covering public key infrastructure, cybersecurity, electronic trade facilitation, regulatory standards, legislative reform, digital literacy and capacity building; no funding, deliverables or milestones published	ADVANCED
Regulator as root certification authority	The ministry accrediting electronic-signature service providers under the 2019 statute	The regulator states it is the national root certification authority, anchoring the digital trust framework and regulating certificate and certification-service providers	ADVANCED
India cyber security memorandum	Signed July 2025, alongside an entrepreneurship centre agreement	No implementation activity, funding or programme reported since	NO CHANGE

The refusal is the movement. At 30 June 2025 the satellite operator's application was pending with a ministerial exemption from the ownership rule under review; by 22 June 2026 the licence and spectrum had been declined and every reconsideration dismissed, the operator's own late request among them ([regulator account](#)). The ownership requirement itself did not change.

Three network positions advanced. Commercial fifth-generation service went from none in June 2025 to live in three centres by the end of August ([cabinet account](#)); a privately owned mobile network went from announced to launched on 2 September 2025; and 25 towers were inaugurated across nine regions ([tower account](#)).

The measured position that worsened is cyber. Detected vulnerabilities and events rose 39.8% and 56.7% quarter on quarter in the second quarter of 2026, on top of a 37% year-on-year rise across calendar 2025 ([regulator account](#)). The national data centre directed by cabinet in September 2025 has no site, capacity, cost or date at either end of the window.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Governmental interoperability solution	Delivered 2016; no operational status published	No operational status published at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE, LAST STATEMENT 2016
Inter-ministry data-exchange platform	Being deployed	No record since 2025-09-03	NO CHANGE, NO LATER RECORD
National data exchange service bus	In operation per a 2020 case study	No operational statement published at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE, LAST STATEMENT 2020

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Electronic identity fee schedule	None published	Free at the point of issue for first-time applicants, renewals of expired cards, amendments and holders replacing cards carrying errors; a first duplicate costs N\$150 and a second N\$300	ADVANCED
Electronic identity public awareness campaign	The campaign opened in Khomas; a conference on digital legal identity held in Windhoek 2025-06-26	Regional outreach by home affairs with a development agency and the regulator, with a brand ambassador running sessions in local languages	ADVANCED
National electronic identity card	A launch announced for July 2026; card design, fees and number scheme unpublished	A September 2026 rollout confirmed; a chipped card holding biometric and biographical data plus a digital identity component for remote authentication, carrying a thumbprint, a facial image and a PIN issued as on a bank card, and valid for 10 years against the indefinite lifespan of the document it replaces	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Randomly generated identity number	Identity numbers derived from date of birth; no change on record	A random number for first-time applicants, with legacy numbers retained on the reverse of the card and existing documents valid until withdrawn by gazette notice	ADVANCED
School-based identity registration drive	Did not exist	Officials return to each school to hand printed documents to learners rather than requiring a ministry visit	ADVANCED
Identity card for refugees	Issuing since June 2024, no annual figure published	682 cards issued in calendar 2025	NO CHANGE
Identity documents issued in calendar 2025	BASELINE NOT HELD	117,175 national identity documents, 126,737 birth certificates and 682 refugee cards issued in 2025	Baseline not held
Printed identity documents left uncollected	BASELINE NOT HELD	166,237 printed, 125,999 collected and 40,238 uncollected, about a quarter of the print run	Baseline not held
Youth e-ID Ambassadors Programme	Baseline not held	A programme using young people to promote take-up of the electronic identity and civic participation; participant numbers, cost, duration and any enrolment effect are not stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Declaration of intent on instant payments integration	Did not exist	Signed to integrate instant payments with the national clearing infrastructure through the interbank settlement system; no deliverables, funding or timetable published	ADVANCED
Instant Payment Solution	In build; core-banking integration tested and user-acceptance testing under way	Operational from June 2026 after a live pilot, with a phased national rollout and government-to-person social grants the first use case	ADVANCED
Interbank settlement system	In operation; no migration on record	Migrated to the ISO 20022 messaging standard	ADVANCED
National Payment System Strategy 2021-2025	In force, in its final year	The period closed at an 87% average implementation rate, succeeded by a payments vision to 2030	CLOSED
National Payment System Vision 2030	The 2021-2025 strategy in force in its final year; no successor on record	Named as the successor frame with its next phase in drafting; priorities are interoperable instant payments, the quick-response standard, open banking and cyber resilience; no document held	ADVANCED
UnionPay e-commerce acceptance	A Standard Bank and UnionPay collaboration since 2024, with no online acceptance on record	Online acceptance open to participating merchants, settling in local currency, US dollars or both	ADVANCED
Cash assistance to refugees through mobile money	Operating; the agency reported holding 40% of the resources needed	No record since February 2025	NO CHANGE, NO LATER RECORD
Participation in the pan-African payment and settlement system	Integration being pursued, not live	No record of Namibian participation at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE
Payment System Management Act 14 of 2023	In force	In force; the payments association moved from a management council to a management board under it during 2025	NO CHANGE
National quick-response payment standard	BASELINE NOT HELD	The standard finalised, with operationalisation named a priority under the payments vision to 2030; no live deployment reported	Baseline not held
Open banking specifications	BASELINE NOT HELD	Completed, with implementation named a priority under the payments vision to 2030 and no implementation date published	Baseline not held
Transfer of payment-provider licensing to the central bank	BASELINE NOT HELD	Licensing and supervision to move to the central bank, with the association given independent governance, its own funding model and a management board; no instrument, commencement date or transition plan published	Baseline not held

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Business and intellectual property online registration	Online registration services offered	Online registration services offered; no transaction or uptake figure published	NO CHANGE
Civil Registration and Identification Act 13 of 2024	In force as the statutory basis for a single civil register, a unique identity number and identity-data confidentiality	Unchanged; read by officials on 2026-07-25 as permitting institutions to accept either the physical card or its digital version, with disclosure conditional on the holder's consent	NO CHANGE
Civil registration department budget	N\$178,122,000 for 2025/26, about US\$9.7m at the publisher's 2025 conversion	No 2026/27 civil-registration allocation on file at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE, NO 2026/27 FIGURE PUBLISHED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National population registration system	Operating; a 2021 baseline found obsolete software, siloed databases and little interoperability	Operating, with remote biometric enrolment tested through hand-held devices	NO CHANGE

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital Community System for community health workers	None published; the base carried only the national electronic health strategy 2021-2025	A mobile application for community health workers in preparation, with phased deployment and paper and digital running in parallel	ADVANCED
National Digital Health Policy 2026-2036	Did not exist	Launched 2026-02-06 as a ten-year framework developed by the health ministry with World Health Organization technical support, naming interoperability across health information systems, service delivery, governance and evidence-based decision-making as the problem it addresses; no funding, implementation plan or target is published	ADVANCED
National eHealth Strategy 2021-2025	In force, in its final year	The period expired 2025-12-31 and a successor policy was launched 2026-02-06	CLOSED, NO SUCCESSOR ON FILE
Roads Authority project control system	Did not exist	A N\$13 million system commissioned by the works and transport ministry to monitor budgets, expenditure, schedules, contractor performance and life-cycle planning across a road network valued at N\$230 billion and nearly 50,000 km	ADVANCED

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Legally recognised electronic signatures	Accreditation of service providers under way, deployment targeted February 2026	No launch on record at 2026-08-06; the capability is now described as a component of the September 2026 identity card	STALLED
Digital Government Strategic Roadmap 2024-2026	In force over its 2024-2026 period; no coverage figure on record	In force; no digital-identity coverage figure published, and card issuance begins only in September 2026	NO CHANGE
Target of full digitisation of government services by 2029/30	Target stated; no delivery measure published	Target unchanged; no delivery measure published at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE

The identity card slipped by two months and gained a fee schedule. A July 2026 launch announced in June 2025 became a September 2026 rollout ([ministry account](#)), and the ministry confirmed on 28 July that the card is free for first-time applicants, renewals of expired cards and amendments ([costs account](#)). No card had been issued at 6 August.

Payments moved further. The instant payment solution went from a build with core-banking integration under test to operational in June 2026 with three participating institutions ([central bank account](#)), the 2021-2025 payments strategy closed at an 87% average implementation rate, and a successor vision to 2030 entered drafting ([report account](#)).

The electronic signature regime is the row marked *Stalled*: accreditation of service providers was under way in September 2025 with nationwide deployment stated for February 2026, and no source records the deployment happening ([signature account](#)). The capability is now described as a component of the September 2026 card. Three data-exchange systems named across ten years — a 2016 interoperability solution, a 2020 service bus and a 2025 inter-ministry platform — have no stated relationship, operating body or governance rules at either end.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Windhoek People-Centred Smart City Strategy 2026-2036	Smart-city development under discussion; no strategy, financing or instrument published (2025-09-23)	Adopted 2026-06-15 and handed over in partnership with UN-Habitat and the United Nations Innovation Technology Accelerator for Cities; the named projects are commercialisation of the city's own fibre-optic network as the digital backbone and a proposed commuter rail linking Windhoek, Katutura and Rehoboth; no funding requirement, implementation timetable or institutional owner is published, and a Chinese contribution to the pilot was acknowledged 2026-07-08	ADVANCED

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Satellite connectivity partnership with Angola	A proof of concept under way; discussions began June 2025	A pilot commercial agreement between the state fixed operator and Angola's space agency, with full commercial launch targeted after the pilot	ADVANCED

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
AI and satellite crop-monitoring contract	A N\$39.5 million agreement with a United States agricultural technology company for an AI and satellite-imagery crop monitoring system	Cabinet ordered the one-year remote sensing agricultural services agreement cancelled in the week of 17 August 2026, and the agriculture ministry is weighing action against the official who authorised it. The contract, in effect from 16 June 2026 and valued at N\$39.5m, was to build a national crop-monitoring system using satellite imagery, geospatial analysis and artificial intelligence to map agricultural land, monitor crop and pasture health and forecast maize, mahangu, sorghum, cowpea and wheat production, with software, models and technical expertise transferred to the ministry and officials trained to run it independently; government did not attribute the cancellation to the technology	REGRESSED
Artificial-intelligence readiness assessment	Completed (2025)	Completed; the findings were restated by the research council's authors on 2026-02-16	NO CHANGE
Artificial-intelligence working group of the research council	Operating; contributed to the artificial-intelligence readiness assessment	Operating; runs the national strategy process	NO CHANGE
National artificial-intelligence institute	Proposed, not established	Proposed, not established; no site, budget, host or founding instrument on file	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Artificial-intelligence agricultural monitoring contract	Not held	A one-year contract with a United States firm at N\$39.5m, about US\$2.4m, introducing satellite imagery, remote sensing and artificial-intelligence monitoring of mahangu, maize, sorghum, cowpea and wheat; the agriculture ministry says Namibia retains ownership of the satellite and crop data generated and will receive model and skills transfer. The award drew public objection over transparency and local participation	BASELINE NOT HELD
Indigenous-language voice-data repository	Baseline not held	A voice-data repository for Namibian indigenous languages being built through the development programme's artificial-intelligence sprint with the national science and technology university; no language count, corpus size, licence or release date is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Space Science and Technology Bill drafting approval	Drafting approved by cabinet; no text published	Drafting approved; no bill, text or timetable published at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
University artificial-intelligence and robotics accelerator	Operating (2025, year precision)	Operating; supports bachelor's and honours degrees in artificial intelligence and a master's in data science	NO CHANGE
Information technology venture capital fund	BASELINE NOT HELD	Authorised at US\$20m; no fund manager, first close, instrument, Namibian-dollar figure or disbursement on file at 2026-08-06	<i>Baseline not held</i>

The strategy went from absent to in consultation. In February 2026 the research council's own authors wrote that Namibia lacks a national artificial-intelligence strategy and lacks comprehensive legislation for data protection and cybersecurity ([council paper](#)); by 3 August the ministry stated consultations had begun and that legislation is sequenced behind the strategy ([ministerial account](#)).

Two objects entered the record that did not exist at the start of the window: the satellite data-receiving ground station handed over on 12 February 2026, stated to be wholly Namibia-run ([handover account](#)), and founding partnership in a pan-African language artificial-intelligence initiative launched on 24 July 2026 ([launch account](#)).

Two did not move. A national artificial-intelligence institute recommended by a 2022 task force is proposed and unestablished at both ends, and the venture capital fund authorised by cabinet in September 2025 has no manager, first close, instrument or disbursement on record ([cabinet account](#)).

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Information and Communication school syllabus	In implementation; the senior secondary Grade 12 syllabus was published in 2018 by the education ministry's national institute for educational development, for implementation in 2021	In implementation across Grades 8, 9 and 12 at least: Information and Communication is a compulsory, non-promotional but assessable subject for Grade 4-12, run across three themes - Digital Literacy, Media Literacy and Information Literacy; the Grade 12 syllabus was published in 2018 for 2021 implementation and the Grade 8 & 9 syllabus in December 2024 for phased implementation in 2025 and 2026; no standalone national digital-literacy strategy or programme exists outside this curriculum	ADVANCED

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Government technology staff cyber-skills programme	Did not exist	Cabinet-approved targeted training in cyber hygiene, incident response and threat intelligence; no delivery, budget or cohort reported at 2026-08-06	ADVANCED

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Financial inclusion rate	78%, described as current by an industry executive (2025-07)	86% (2025), with the same 78% dated to 2017	ADVANCED, DATING UNRECONCILED
Free internet for schools and clinics under new towers	Not on record; 339 schools and 50 health centres reported without adequate connectivity (2025-06)	Free internet for seven years to schools and clinics under towers built in the previous two years; N\$80m in nine radio access network towers over two years	ADVANCED
100% telecommunications coverage by 2030	Target announced; about 360,000 people, roughly 12%, outside fourth-generation coverage at February 2024	Target unchanged; no later official coverage figure held, and the sixth national development plan carries a parallel internet-use target of 53% to 90% by 2030	NO CHANGE
Namibia Learning Passport	Not held	Launched by the education ministry with UNICEF as a digital and offline learning platform aimed at rural, remote and underserved young people	BASELINE NOT HELD
School connectivity in Kavango West	BASELINE NOT HELD	21 of Kavango West's 188 schools have workable connectivity, leaving 55,002 learners without digital teaching tools, and Kavango East's 197 schools serving 86,282 learners are reported only marginally connected	Baseline not held

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Regulator sector and market report series	Published; four editions on file, the latest reporting 2023 data	Published as an irregular series - an earlier Telecommunication Sector Market Report in October 2021, the Telecommunication Sector Market Report 2021 in November 2022, the ICT Sector Market Report 2022 in December 2023 and the ICT Sector Market Report 2023 in November 2024 - built on licensees' audited financial statements and the regulator's own portal data	NO CHANGE
Schools and health facilities without adequate connectivity	339 schools and 50 health centres lacking adequate connectivity (2025-06)	No later official figure; a research council account records 65.4% of schools connected in 2023, 1,311 of 2,004	NO CHANGE, NO LATER FIGURE PUBLISHED

The one movement the state itself measures is financial inclusion, from 78% in 2017 to 86% in 2025 ([central bank account](#)) – a series whose earlier value a second held source described as current in July 2025, eight years out.

Connectivity commitments were restated rather than delivered against. The 100% coverage target for 2030 stands unchanged with no later official coverage figure ([ministry account](#)), the tax-relief proposal on fourth-generation devices made in February 2026 has produced no fiscal instrument or ministerial response, and the free-internet undertaking for schools and clinics under new towers still has no list or count of covered sites.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Namibia Statistics Agency Strategic Plan 2022/23-2026/27	Did not exist	In force for 2022/23-2026/27: four strategic focus areas - statistical coordination (including National Spatial Data Infrastructure coordination), sustainability (adequate government funding), institutional reform and innovation (including alternative data sources), and professionalism; the plan states funding was relatively adequate until about 2016 and records the population census slipping from August 2021 and again from August 2022 for want of funds	ADVANCED
National strategy for the development of statistics	Did not exist	In force covering 2023/24-2026/27: four goals - better use of statistics for policy, efficient and effective data processes, a better funded national statistics system, and improved statistical integration with spatial data - resting on ten first-phase sector statistics plans (education, environment, tourism, the revenue authority, child care and protection, health, industrial development, labour, agriculture and the NSA itself); total implementation cost N\$58,995,000 over four years off a 2019 baseline, drafted with AfDB, Paris21, UNDP and UNFPA support and stated to be aimed at improving Namibia's World Bank Statistical Capacity Indicator rating	ADVANCED
Producer price index compilation system	Compiled on a legacy spreadsheet system, with missing prices imputed by unweighted class mean	Compilation moved to an automated processing engine, disclosed in the second-quarter 2026 bulletin released on 21 August 2026 and carrying retrospective revisions of producer price estimates back to 2015: missing prices are now imputed as a turnover-weighted average of observed price relatives within the product group, imputation is capped at three consecutive periods before an item must be replaced, and automated validation flags extreme swings and entry errors across establishment files, with aggregation on a modified Laspeyres formula excluding VAT, excise and transport	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Statistics agency microdata catalogue and data portals	Did not exist	NSA operates a Data Portals page (Namibia Data Portal, National Summary Data, Geo Portal, mobile application, SCAN ICT, COVID-19 dashboard) and a NADA-based microdata catalogue holding 16 Namibian studies from 1992 to 2023, each carrying a stated access term (open data access, public use data files, direct data access, or external repository); this is agency-run data dissemination, not a government-wide open data policy or portal	ADVANCED
Statistics Awareness Day	Did not exist	The inaugural event held 2026-07-27, themed statistics in the digital age	ADVANCED
2023 population and housing census	Completed; the reference population count	Still the reference count, cited by the statistics agency as a step in modernising the national statistical system	NO CHANGE
Special data dissemination standard subscription	Subscribed	Subscribed	NO CHANGE

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Access to Information Act 8 of 2022 and the Information Commissioner	Gazetted, not in force	Gazetted and not commenced: section 86 leaves commencement to a date determined by the Minister, no commencement notice is held, and no Information Commissioner has been appointed; appointment machinery was itself gazetted 2024-12-09 under section 6(9), setting five-year Selection Committee terms and a five-member quorum, made ahead of the Act's own commencement, so the annual report required by section 18 cannot yet exist	ADVANCED, ACT STILL NOT COMMENCED
CityMender infrastructure reporting platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	A free application taking public reports of more than thirty kinds of infrastructure and service-delivery fault onto a mapped national dataset, with automatic facial and licence-plate redaction	Baseline not held
Multilateral Environmental Agreements monitoring and reporting platform	Not held	Launched by the environment ministry at N\$12m, built with UNDP and funded by the Global Environment Facility under a land-governance project, to centralise environmental data for planning, decision-making and national reporting, with the national university as technical and academic partner	BASELINE NOT HELD

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Satellite data-receiving ground station	Did not exist	In operation, Namibia's first such facility, receiving remote-sensing data and operated by fourteen trained Namibians	ADVANCED
Space Science and Technology Bill	Drafting approved in 2025; no text published	No text or introduction date published at 2026-08-06	NO CHANGE, NO DRAFT PUBLISHED

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Subsea cable landing at Swakopmund	In service (2022)	In service; cited as the connectivity leg of the case for hosting compute in Namibia	NO CHANGE

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Chinese contribution to the Windhoek smart city pilot	Did not exist	CNY 98,000,000 committed, about US\$14.4m on the source's 2026 conversion, for digital infrastructure, artificial-intelligence capability and skills under the ten-year city strategy	ADVANCED

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
European Union Multi-Annual Indicative Programme 2021-2027	In force; EUR 26,000,000 indicative for 2025-2027, with nil for foundational skills education	In force with no digital priority area: digitalisation is listed as a cross-cutting priority, the named digital offer is support to the Namibian Parliament's e-Parliament blueprint, and the 2025-2027 allocation set at the mid-term review is EUR 26,000,000 - inclusive green growth 20, good governance and gender equality 2, support measures 4, foundational skills education nil	NO CHANGE

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Gulf-state digital or artificial-intelligence cooperation agreement	Did not exist	Proposed only: a Bilateral Economic Commission with technology transfer, skills development, industrialisation and manufacturing in its remit; the UAE side raised investment protection and double-taxation agreements; no Gulf-state digital, data-centre or artificial-intelligence agreement is published at 2026-08-09	ADVANCED

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
PARAM HPC cluster at NUST	Did not exist	A 5-node C-DAC PARAM HPC cluster (17.7 TF Rpeak, 5,320 cores, 480 GB memory, 100 TB storage plus 54 TB backup) specified for deployment at NUST, Windhoek, under the India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in Information Technology; no operator, cost or opening date is published, and this is a university research cluster, not a national facility	ADVANCED
India bilateral cybersecurity and digital-economy cooperation	Not held	Advanced at the fourth joint trade committee in New Delhi on 12 August 2026, building on a memorandum signed by the two heads of government in July 2025; bilateral trade is put at more than US\$592m in 2025/26	BASELINE NOT HELD

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Consultancy engagement on the artificial-intelligence framework	A procurement award notice, terms of reference or signed advisory agreement; the base carries two accounts of a 2026-08-03 meeting and the minister's statement that the research council leads, and no contract, scope of work, procurement route or value, with none listed on the central procurement board	2026-08-06
National high-performance computing facility	A research council or ministry announcement, procurement notice or budget line for a national compute facility; the base carries the council's own statement that its data committee is to provide such centres and that securing computing infrastructure is a next step, and separately that a vendor is building a data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads, with no named facility, site, capacity, cost or operator	2026-08-06

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Start-up act	A gazetted act or a published bill; a held source records that at 2026-08-09 no gazetted or tabled start-up legislation could be located and that the nearest policy instrument, the National Informal Economy, Start-ups and Entrepreneurship Development Policy, is not published at any URL, so what is outstanding is confirmation that none exists rather than a document	2026-08-06
Government interoperability framework	A published interoperability framework, standard or governing instrument; the base names three data-exchange objects across ten years and establishes no relationship between them, no operating body and no governance rules	2026-08-06
Payments association 2025 annual report	The report itself; the base holds two press accounts of its 2026-07-28 release and no primary, and the association's own site publishes only a memorandum and a board release, so four payment rows stand on press reporting of one unheld document	2026-08-06
National open data policy or government portal	A portal address, a dataset catalogue or a policy document; the subject holds nothing for Namibia, and the nearest held material is central bank and statistics agency statements on administrative data, which concern data quality rather than publication	2026-08-06
Published draft and consultation record of the Data Protection Bill	A ministry consultation notice, submissions register or committee record; the base carries only two sources on this subject and a researcher's statement that the public had not seen the latest draft at 2025-08-17	2026-08-06
Smart-city grant agreement and annexures	The signed grant agreement, its annexures, the contractor list and the data architecture; the base carries an opposition member's characterisation and a presidential acknowledgement of the amount, with no instrument text, and does not establish the Chinese disbursing agency	2026-08-06
Ratification of the continental convention on cyber security and personal data protection	The continental depositary list entry or a Namibian instrument of ratification or accession; the base carries 20 sources on this subject, all bilateral or convened by an industry body, and none names a continental or regional data-governance instrument Namibia has acceded to	2026-08-06
National digital literacy programme	A named ministry or regulator digital-literacy strategy, curriculum or programme document; the subject carries exactly one Namibian source, the regulator and chamber memorandum of 2026-07-30, which names digital literacy as a workstream with no funding, deliverable or target	2026-08-06
Information and communications technology ministry budget vote	The ministry's vote in the appropriation bill or its budget-vote motivation speech; the base holds no Namibian technology appropriation of any year, and the one appropriation figure held anywhere in the base is the civil registration department's, on a source tagged to other subjects	2026-08-06
Universal Service Fund annual accounts	The fund's annual report, or the regulator's disclosure of levy receipts and project disbursements; the base establishes the fund exists, its launch month, its initial endowment and two in-kind outputs, all from secondary reporting of ministerial statements, and carries no levy rate, contribution base, receipts or project list	2026-08-06
Power supply plan for the national data centre	A power purchase agreement, grid-connection study or energy annex to the data-centre project proposal; the subject carries one Namibian source, a signed opinion piece arguing the case for hosting compute locally, so there is no held statement of how any planned facility would be powered, at what cost, or by whom	2026-08-06

Twenty-two rows are *Not held* at both ends, and all 22 were searched on 6 August. Nineteen name published documents and three are searched absences.

The one that most constrains this report is the regulator's absent sector report. Namibia refused a licence on national-security and ownership grounds, set a 2030 coverage target and built 25 towers inside the window — and the wiki cannot state a single dated Namibian coverage or subscriber figure on the regulator's own authority, because none is published in anything held.

The second is the payments association's annual report. Four positions in the digital public infrastructure section — the quick-response standard, open banking, the settlement migration and the closing implementation rate of the 2021-2025 strategy — rest entirely on press accounts of a document the wiki does not hold, and the probe of 6 August found it published nowhere but the association's own site, which refuses automated clients.

The third is the smart-city agreement. A member of parliament asked on 4 August for its annexures, contractors, data architecture and lifetime operating costs; none of those is held, and neither is the disbursing agency.

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.